

The Price Conundrum

According to the report, mobile gamers tend to spend more on handsets—an average of 57 percent more. They also tend to be heavier users of their mobile phones for regular calls, using 48 percent more wireless minutes than non-gamers, and their monthly wireless bills are 22 percent higher than the average subscriber.

But not all of the news is positive for the mobile gaming industry. According to the report, there's a significant price sensitivity issue, which is inhibiting the industry from really taking off. That helps explain why only about one-third of mobile gamers actually buy the games themselves. The remaining two-thirds are satisfied playing free or pre-loaded games. And just like digital music, the dominant purchase model is single downloads, while monthly subscriptions barely show up on consumer's radars.